

Alpaca API keys

Go through this step by step, and it's easy. Take your time. Grab a coffee and relax with it.

Summary:

1. Get your new Alpaca keys
2. Tell Claude you want to work locally with this keys to prevent conflict with the Railway project holding the original Alpaca keys
3. Do what Claude says 😊

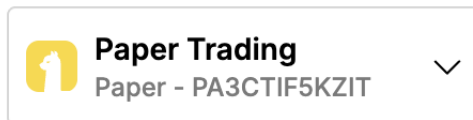
Due to Alpaca only allowing 1 set of API keys per user, We need 3 unique Alpaca API keys to edit this website.

1. The keys on GitHub / Railway are in, saved and working - and we shouldn't touch them 
2. I have set up new API keys for my laptop only - so they don't conflict with Alpaca's 
3. You need to set up your own API keys from Alpaca, so you can use your computer and not conflict with the railway keys

Instructions to get your keys and set up your computer with them.

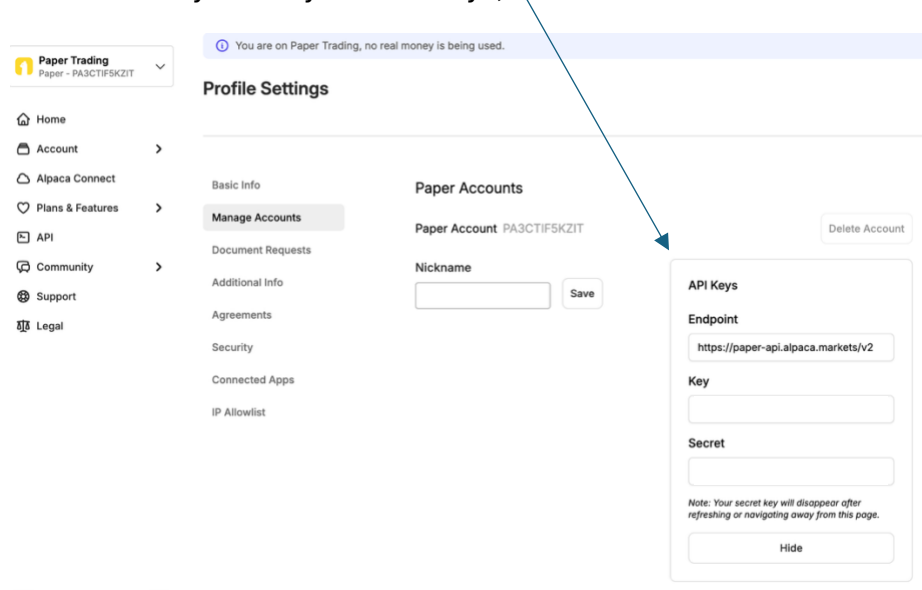
Getting Keys:

1. Go to <https://alpaca.markets/>
2. Sign in / Sign up
3. Set up 2 factor authentication on the Google Authenticator App
 - a. Then you're logged in and ready to go
4. Click this menu,



5. then go down to Account Management, then generate new keys (bottom right)

6. When you see your new keys,



Saving the keys on your laptop:

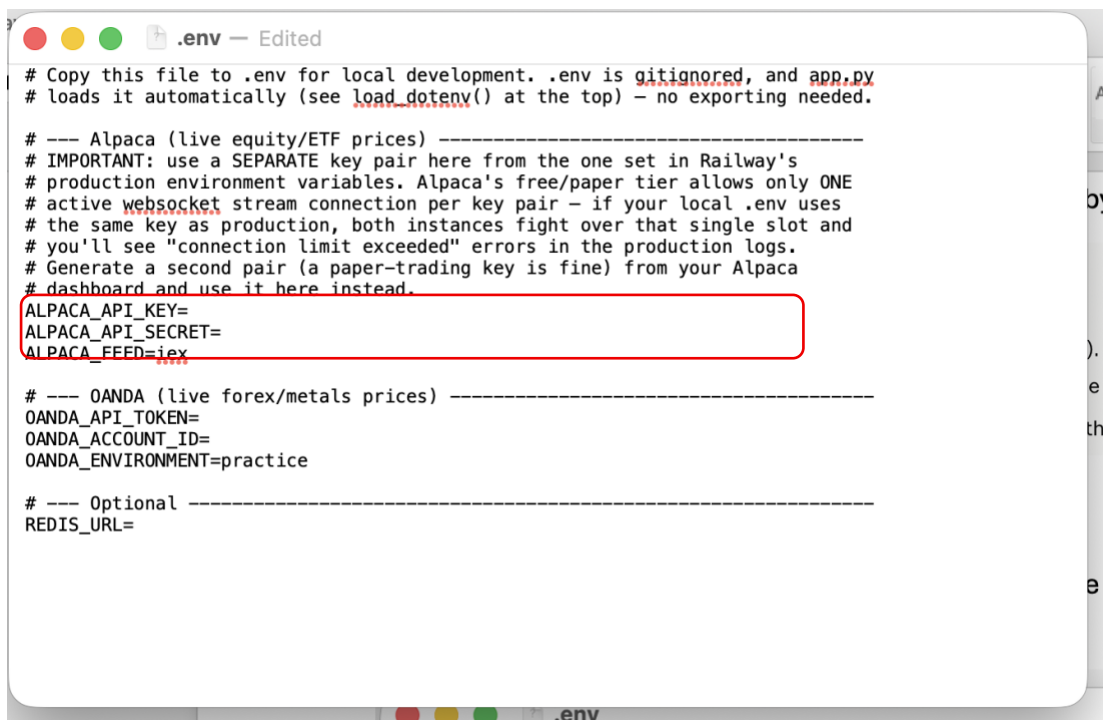
7. You can go to Claude and ask him to create a file called `.env`
8. Claude will create this file, then save it in your AI Investor folder
9. It will be a hidden file, so you'll have to unhide it by:

On Windows, in File Explorer:

1. Open File Explorer.
2. Click the View menu at the top (on Windows 11, click "View" → "Show").
3. Select Show → Hidden items (Windows 11) or check Hidden items in the View tab (Windows 10).

That reveals hidden files and folders, including dotfiles like `.env`. To hide them again, just uncheck the same option.

10. In this file you will paste the keys in the right place (see red rectangle)



```
.env — Edited

# Copy this file to .env for local development. .env is gitignored, and app.py
# loads it automatically (see load_dotenv() at the top) – no exporting needed.

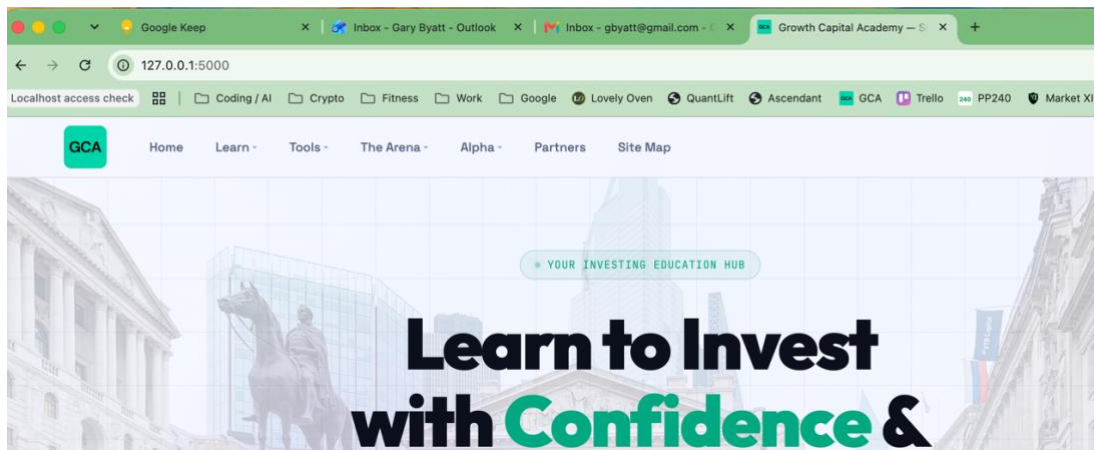
# --- Alpaca (live equity/ETF prices) -----
# IMPORTANT: use a SEPARATE key pair here from the one set in Railway's
# production environment variables. Alpaca's free/paper tier allows only ONE
# active websocket stream connection per key pair – if your local .env uses
# the same key as production, both instances fight over that single slot and
# you'll see "connection limit exceeded" errors in the production logs.
# Generate a second pair (a paper-trading key is fine) from your Alpaca
# dashboard and use it here instead.
ALPACA_API_KEY=
ALPACA_API_SECRET=
ALPACA_FEED=iex

# --- OANDA (live forex/metals prices) -----
OANDA_API_TOKEN=
OANDA_ACCOUNT_ID=
OANDA_ENVIRONMENT=practice

# --- Optional -----
REDIS_URL=
```

Editing the website from now on:

11. After you save that, Claude can open a “Local Server” for you to test on.
So we don't upload everything to GitHub all the time and make Alpaca confused.
12. When Claude opens this local server, it'll be open in your browser but running only on your computer - not the internet. Not saved on Github, just on your machine. Note the 127.0.0.1:5000 in the address bar - this means it's only on your computer and not uploaded yet.



12. When you've done some work and want it live on the website, ask Claude to "commit and push it"

There may be some issues with things like downloading the Alpaca-py package and stuff like that. But Claude will sort it easily. *This is not your fault - it's just Claude getting the stuff he needs to work on the system.*

Summary:

1. Get your new Alpaca keys
2. Tell Claude you want to work locally with this keys to prevent conflict with the Railway project holding the original Alpaca keys
3. Do what Claude says 😊
4. Ask Claude to check if it worked